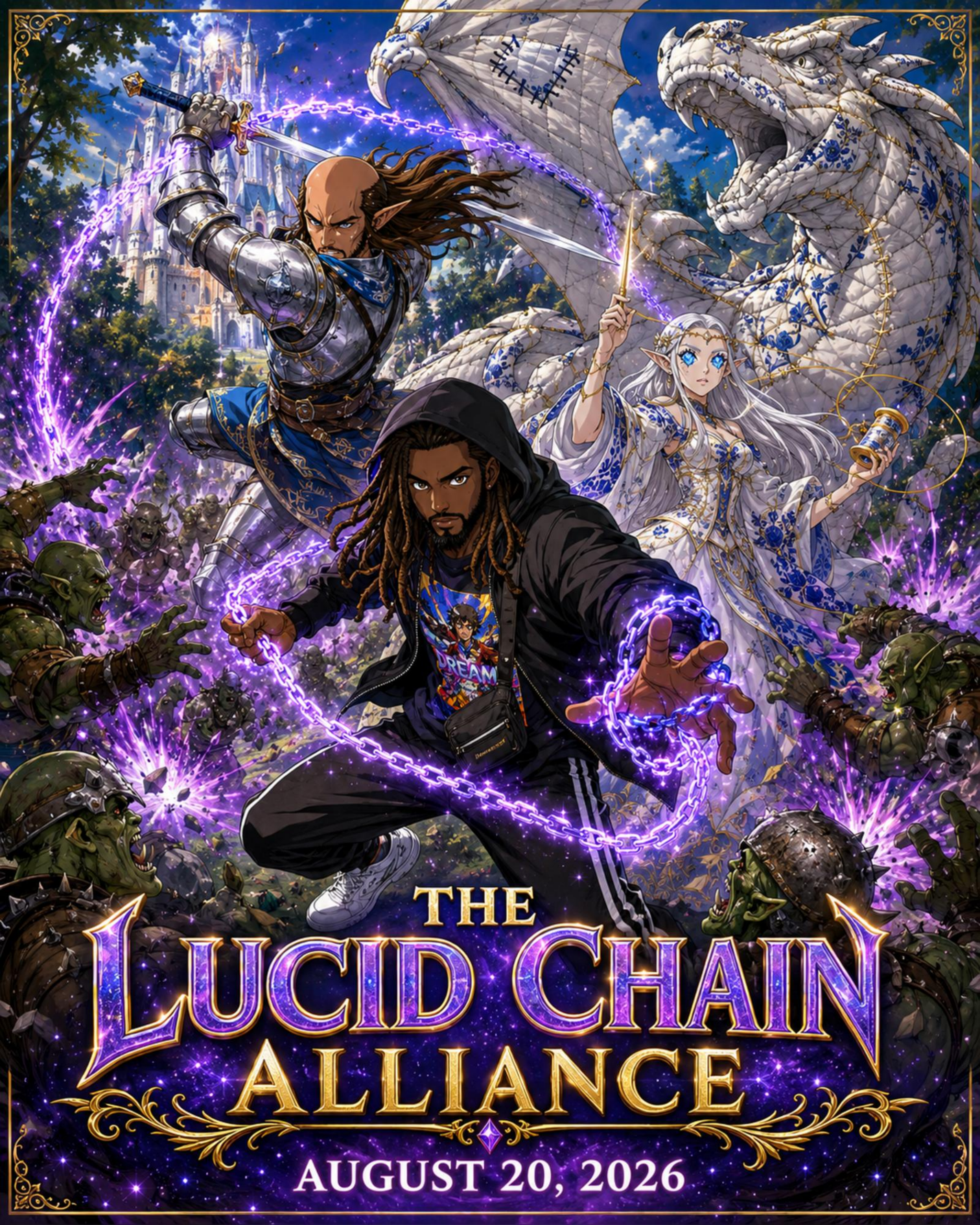




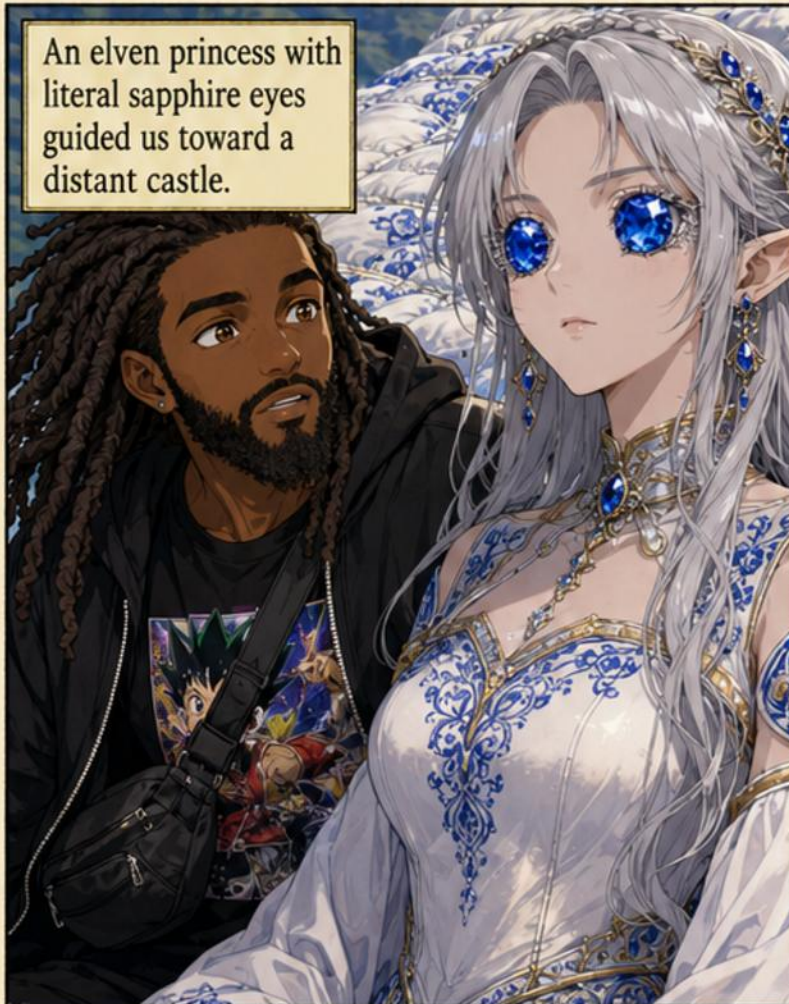
THE LUCID CHAIN ALLIANCE

AUGUST 20, 2026

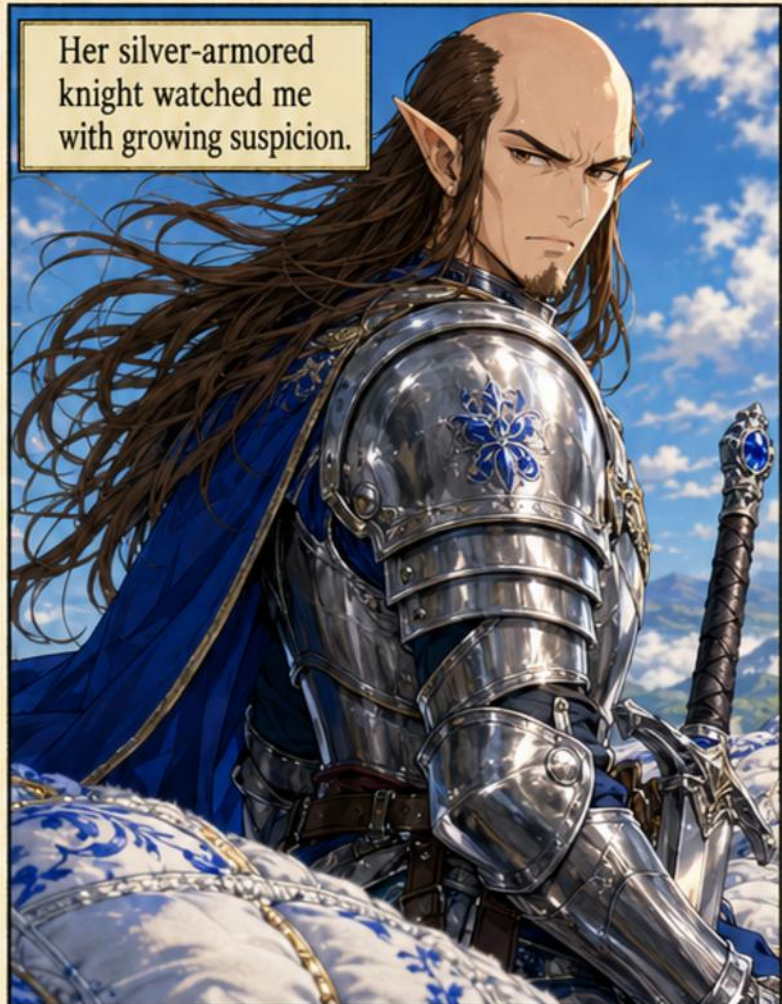
Above an endless forest, I rode a living dragon sewn from quilted fabric and patterned like blue-and-white china.



An elven princess with literal sapphire eyes guided us toward a distant castle.



Her silver-armored knight watched me with growing suspicion.



Her jeweled eyes were stunning enough that I said so.



She laughed. Her boyfriend—apparently soon to be her ex—did not.



I stepped between them and summoned a ring of Lucid Light. The knight stole it from my hand.



So I moved it to his back, turned it into a parachute, and launched him safely overboard.



The princess did not laugh. The forest below was swarming with hostile orcs.



An enchanted strike tore the quilted dragon's wing and forced us into a clearing.



While she conjured needles and thread to repair it, I promised to retrieve the knight.



His ring had a sister. I expected mine to pull him back to us.



The paired rings worked perfectly—in reverse.



Instead of pulling the knight to me, mine yanked me through the trees toward him.



I struck the outer wall of an orc circle and found the knight trapped at its center.



When the orcs turned on me, I made the bond between our rings visible.



A massive chain of sparkling Lucid Light caught every blow.



Each impact sent a shockwave through the attackers.



Then I realized the knight at the other end was carrying a sword.



I swung the knight around the circle like a living flail.



He understood immediately and turned every pass into a sword strike.



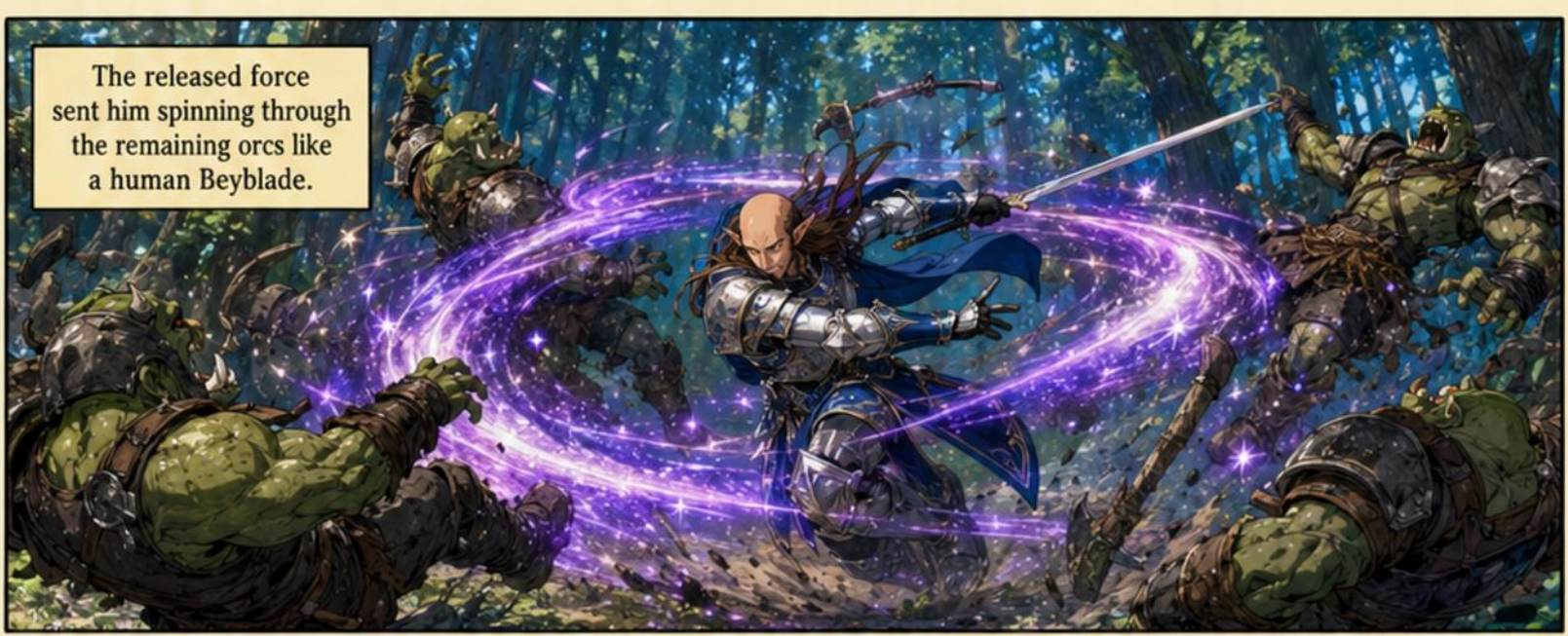
Our argument vanished inside the rhythm of a ridiculous, spectacular team attack.



For the finish, I pulled until the chain broke.



The released force sent him spinning through the remaining orcs like a human Beyblade.



When the last enemy fell, the knight looked at me as an ally instead of a rival.



We returned to the clearing together, where the princess had sewn the dragon whole.



Beside the repaired quilted dragen, our strange new alliance completed the dream.

